

# Armored Cars

Early tanks were unreliable: their tracks were prone to breaking on rough ground or when handled poorly, and they wore out relatively quickly. Wheeled vehicles, on the other hand, were much more durable, often carried similar firepower and armor protection, and were quieter, and usually faster, except over the roughest terrain. These qualities made armored cars ideal as patrol vehicles, as the British used them in India. Other countries used them for reconnoitering ahead of their tank forces.

▷ **Rolls-Royce Armored Car**

|                      |                                        |                |    |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------|----|
| <b>Date</b>          | 1920                                   | <b>Country</b> | UK |
| <b>Weight</b>        | 4.8 tons (4.3 tonnes)                  |                |    |
| <b>Engine</b>        | Rolls-Royce 6-cylinder gasoline, 80 hp |                |    |
| <b>Main armament</b> | .303 Vickers machine gun               |                |    |

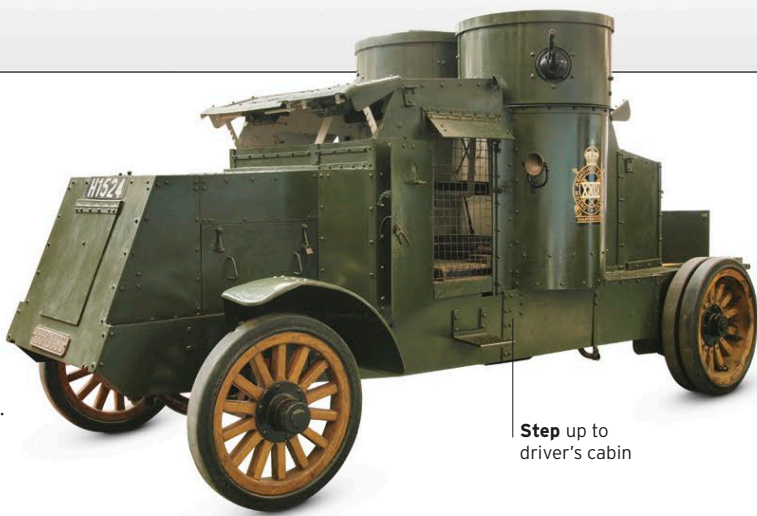
The 1920 Pattern Rolls-Royce was very similar to the Royal Navy's 1914 Pattern. It was used by the British Army and Royal Air Force around the world, including in Ireland, Iraq, Shanghai, and Egypt. Some upgraded 1920 and 1924 Pattern vehicles were used in the North African Desert Campaign in 1940 and 1941.



▽ **Lanchester Armored Car**

|                      |                                       |                |    |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------|----|
| <b>Date</b>          | 1931                                  | <b>Country</b> | UK |
| <b>Weight</b>        | 7.8 tons (7.1 tonnes)                 |                |    |
| <b>Engine</b>        | Lanchester 6-cylinder gasoline, 90 hp |                |    |
| <b>Main armament</b> | .50 Vickers machine gun               |                |    |

This vehicle was very different to its wartime namesake (see p.34). Larger and heavier, it had four driven wheels at the rear, a second, rear-facing driver's space at the back, and two additional .303 Vickers machine guns. Thirty-nine were built, 10 carrying a radio instead of the hull Vickers gun. Some survived to fight the Japanese in Malaya in 1941-42.



◁ **Peerless Armored Car**

|                      |                                        |                |    |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------|----|
| <b>Date</b>          | 1919                                   | <b>Country</b> | UK |
| <b>Weight</b>        | 7.7 tons (7 tonnes)                    |                |    |
| <b>Engine</b>        | Peerless 4-cylinder gasoline, 40 hp    |                |    |
| <b>Main armament</b> | 2 x .303 Hotchkiss Mark I machine-guns |                |    |

This vehicle paired an armored body supplied by Austin with a Peerless truck chassis. Service in Ireland revealed it to be big and slow, and its solid rubber tires uncomfortable. It was passed on to the Territorial Army, where it was kept by some units until the late 1930s.

▷ **Sd Kfz 231 6 rad Armored Car**

|                      |                              |                |         |
|----------------------|------------------------------|----------------|---------|
| <b>Date</b>          | 1932                         | <b>Country</b> | Germany |
| <b>Weight</b>        | 6 tons (5.4 tonnes)          |                |         |
| <b>Engine</b>        | Magirus M206 gasoline, 70 hp |                |         |
| <b>Main armament</b> | 2cm KwK 30 L/55 cannon       |                |         |

Based on various 6x4 truck chassis, the Sd Kfz 231 began development in 1929. Its crew of four included a second, rear-facing driver. A total of 151 were built. It was used in Austria, Poland, Czechoslovakia, and France, but was withdrawn in 1940 due to poor off-road mobility. This example is a replica.

